

OpenComm — slot booking for art commissions

Scalable Software Engineering · Universitas Gadjah Mada · Semester Ganjil 2026/2027

Team OpenComm

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THE APP

Independent illustrators take paid commissions in rounds called **open comm**. An artist announces a period (say October) and a small number of **slots**. Most run this today on a Google Form, DMs and a spreadsheet, and that setup breaks at the worst moment: when an artist posts “OPEN COMM, 5 SLOTS”, far more people reply than there are slots. The artist ends up with more takers than slots, has to apologise and refund, then spends the month tracking who paid the **DP** (deposit), which sketch is waiting on approval, and who still owes **pelunasan** (the balance). OpenComm gives each artist a booking page for their window that never oversells, and tracks every commission from request to final file.

WHO USES IT

- **Artist** — opens windows, sets prices and terms, accepts or declines requests, delivers sketch and final. Cares about never being overbooked, getting the DP before starting work, and a capped number of revisions.
- **Client** — requests a slot, pays DP and pelunasan, approves the sketch, receives the file. Cares about a fair first-come slot, knowing the price up front, and seeing progress.

THE MAIN FLOW

1. The artist publishes a pricelist and opens a window with N slots.
2. A client sends a request with their brief and references. Nothing is held yet — a request is not an order.
3. The artist reads it and **accepts** (quoting at or above the start-from price) or declines. Accepting **keeps** a slot; if every slot is already kept or taken, the answer is “slots full”.
4. The client pays the DP within 1×24 hours. The slot becomes **taken** and the commission joins the artist’s queue. If the DP is late, the slot is released.
5. The artist sends a sketch. The client approves it or asks for a revision, up to the agreed limit.
6. The artist sends the final preview; the client pays pelunasan.
7. Once that payment is confirmed, the hi-res file is released and the commission is complete.

Shape: **reserve a scarce thing** (steps 1–4) followed by **order, prepare, hand over** (steps 4–7). It crosses three areas of the business — booking, payments, and the studio.

THE HARD RULE

An artist never gets more commissions in a window than the slots they opened, however many clients are competing for the last one.

The load is bursty and self-inflicted. The artist we interviewed reaches around a thousand people with a single post; her last five-slot round drew fifteen to twenty serious enquiries and was full inside thirty to sixty minutes. The collisions are few but real — she has already had two clients arrive together for the last slot, and handles it today by telling one of them to wait. A second rule carries the same weight: a payment is applied exactly once, even if the provider’s callback arrives twice.

WHY THIS IS NOT A MARKETPLACE (R4)

There is no artist discovery, search, ranking, reviews, chat, escrow or dispute handling. Each artist shares a link to their own window on their own social media. Supporting more artists means more tenants, not a catalogue to browse. We do not process images either: sketches and finals are links, and watermarking stays with the artist.

WHO WE WILL INTERVIEW

Eja, an illustrator who runs open comms in batches of about five slots. She answered our questions on 22 September 2026, and we are arranging a 90-minute event-storming session with her on **[date]**.